Rapport Building Topics

Remote Roles · Who you're talking to, and how to talk to them

Five kinds of homeowner, five different calls. The script doesn't change — the way you carry it does. Work out which one you're speaking to inside the first thirty seconds and adjust.

Rapport is not small talk. It is proving you were listening. Every technique below is a way of showing that.

1. The older or retired homeowner

Carry it: patient, unhurried, respectful

- Slow down. Speak clearly. Leave gaps — they may not jump into them straight away, and that's fine.
- The neighbourhood is your way in. They have watched it change and usually have something to say about it.
- Length of ownership is worth asking about and worth reacting to.

"That's a great area. How long have you been there?"

Why: Rushing an older homeowner reads as disrespect, and once it does the call is over whether or not they hang up.

2. The young or busy homeowner

Carry it: direct, efficient, no padding

- Get to the point faster than feels natural. They will respect it.
- Sell convenience rather than price — no showings, no open houses, no repairs.
- Match their pace. If they are clipped, be clipped.

"No showings, no open houses, no repairs, and you pick the closing date. That's the whole thing."

Why: With this one, warmth reads as wasting their time. Brevity is the rapport.

3. The inherited property

Carry it: careful, human, unhurried

- Acknowledge the loss before anything about the house.
- Then stop talking. Let them decide how much to say.
- Position the sale as one less thing to carry, never as an opportunity.

"I'm sorry for your loss. Dealing with a property on top of everything else can be a lot."

Why: This is the call where pushing costs you the most. Someone grieving remembers who handled them badly, and they tell people.

4. The landlord

Carry it: professional, peer to peer

- Speak their language. Tenants, cash flow, vacancy, maintenance.
- Respect what they know — they have done more deals than you have.
- Their motivation is rarely emotional. Find the number or the hassle that's driving it.

"How are the tenants? Is it cash-flowing well for you?"

Why: Talk down to a landlord once and you've lost them. Treat it as one professional calling another.

5. The skeptical homeowner

Carry it: transparent, calm, unoffended

- Name the suspicion before they have to. It disarms faster than any reassurance.
- Be specific about what happens next and what you will not ask for.
- Never sound wounded. Someone who challenges you is still on the phone.

“You're probably thinking this is one of those scam calls. Fair enough — plenty of them are.”

Why: Saying their objection out loud before they do is the single most useful rapport move on this sheet. It works because it proves you aren't reading at them.

Five things that work on everyone

- Match their energy. High energy at a mellow person reads as a sales call.
- Use their name two or three times. Not more — more is salesmanship.
- Mirror the last few words they said, as a question. It restarts them talking without you asking anything.
- Repeat something they told you earlier, later. Nothing proves listening faster.
- Let them finish. The interrupt costs more than whatever you were going to say.

And five that break it

- Talking faster than they are.
- Answering a question they didn't ask.
- Pushing after a second no.
- Sounding word-for-word scripted.
- Fake warmth. People hear it immediately, and it is worse than being flat.